PRIMARY FIVE ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Term One | Week Two | Lesson Four

CONDITIONAL SENTENCES: THE FIRST CONDITIONAL (IF1)

Topic: Conditional sentences

What you will learn

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

1. Recognise the **if-clause** and the **main clause**.
2. Identify the verb forms used in a first conditional sentence.
3. Construct correct sentences about possible future events.
4. Use commas correctly when the if-clause comes first.

1. Meaning

A **conditional sentence** tells us what may happen if a condition is met.

We use the **first conditional (IF1)** to talk about something that may really happen in the future.

Example: If it rains, we will stay indoors.

The rain is possible. Staying indoors is what we will do if it rains.

2. The two parts of IF1

A first conditional sentence normally has two clauses:

Clause	Meaning	Example
If-clause	States the condition	If we study hard
Main clause	States the likely result	we will pass the test.

Put them together:

If we study hard, we will pass the test.

3. How to form IF1

If + subject + present simple, subject + will + base verb.

- If Amina **wakes** early, she **will catch** the school bus.
- If the farmer **waters** the seedlings, they **will grow**.
- If we **leave** now, we **will arrive** on time.
- If I **finish** my work, I **will help** my mother.

Important: In the if-clause, use the **present simple**, not *will*.

Correct: If the sun **shines**, we will play outside.

Incorrect: If the sun **will shine**, we will play outside.

4. Changing the order of clauses

We can put the main clause first without changing the meaning.

- **If** you practise daily, you will improve your handwriting.
- You will improve your handwriting **if** you practise daily.

Punctuation: Put a comma after the if-clause when it comes first. Usually, do not put a comma before *if* when it comes second.

5. Affirmative and negative forms

The condition or result may be negative.

- If we **do not hurry**, we **will miss** the bus.
- If Musa **does not revise**, he **will not do** well in the test.
- If you **eat** the ripe mango, you **will not be** hungry.

Short forms: *do not = don't; does not = doesn't; will not = won't.*

6. Asking questions

We can ask about a possible result.

- **What will happen if it rains?** We will remain inside.
- **Will you visit the library if you finish your homework?** Yes, I will.
- **What will Sarah do if she finds the lost book?** She will return it.

7. Common mistakes and corrections

Incorrect	Correct
If it will rain, we will stay indoors.	If it rains, we will stay indoors.
If she study, she will pass.	If she studies, she will pass.
If I arrive late I will apologise.	If I arrive late, I will apologise.
If you heat ice, it will melts.	If you heat ice, it will melt.
We will be happy if we will win.	We will be happy if we win.

8. Worked examples

Example A. Complete: If I _____ (see) the head teacher, I will greet her.

Use the present simple after *if*.

Answer: If I **see** the head teacher, I will greet her.

Example B. Join the sentences: You will get wet. You do not carry an umbrella.

Make the condition the if-clause.

Answer: If you **do not carry an umbrella**, you **will get wet**.

Example C. Begin with 'We will': If we practise, we will win the match.

Answer: We will win the match if we practise.

EXERCISE

A. Choose the correct verb.

1. If it _____ (rain/rains), the children will stay in class.

_____

2. If Kato _____ (work/works) hard, he will improve.

_____

3. If we leave early, we _____ (will arrive/arrived) before eight.

_____

4. If the goats escape, the farmer _____ (will look/looks) for them.

_____

5. If she _____ (find/finds) the pencil, she will return it.

_____

6. If they win, they _____ (celebrate/will celebrate) after the match.

_____

B. Complete the first conditional sentences.

7. If the classroom is dirty, we _____.

_____

8. If I finish my homework, _____.

_____

9. If the teacher asks a question, _____.

_____

10. If our water tank is empty, _____ .

_____

C. Join the ideas using IF1.

11. It may rain. We will carry umbrellas.

_____

12. You may study carefully. You will understand the topic.

_____

13. We may hurry. We will catch the bus.

_____

14. The pupils may practise. They will sing better.

_____

D. Correct the mistakes.

15. If I will see Asha, I will tell her.

_____

16. If she come early, she will help us.

_____

17. If the bell rings we will enter the classroom.

_____

18. I will carry my sweater if it will be cold.

_____

19. If he finishes his work, he will goes home.

_____

20. If they doesn't water the seedlings, the plants will dry.

_____

E. Change the order of clauses.

21. If the pupils listen carefully, they will understand.

_____

22. The teacher will be pleased if we keep the classroom clean.

_____

23. If I have enough money, I will buy an exercise book.

_____

24. We will stay at home if there is a storm.

_____

F. Write your own IF1 sentences.

25. Write a sentence about getting ready for school.

_____

_____

26. Write a sentence about helping at home.

_____

_____

Remember

- The **if-clause** states the condition; the **main clause** states the result.
- In IF1, use **if + present simple** and **will + base verb**.
- Do **not** put *will* in the ordinary first-conditional if-clause.
- Put a comma after the if-clause when it comes first.